ROAD TO 2028 · EU FUNDING CLINIC · VULCA 2026, CUENCA

Guidelines for Test Lab

“The rural fablab where young people and artists repair and invent”

By 2030: A coordinator

8 November 2026

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Made with the Road to 2028 app by Buinho Creative Hub (Messejana, Portugal), from what you entered. Rules and amounts are those of the 2026 calls: always check the current call.

What your position means

Your answers on the start screen, read with our experience

> **YOUR EXPERIENCE WITH EU PROJECTS**
>
> You told us your lab has never applied. Look at the steps you chose with one question in mind: which of them can you do as a partner in someone else's project, or as a short mobility, before you carry the weight of coordinating?

WHAT YOU HAVE TODAY, AND WHAT TO DO ABOUT IT

People and time ● ○ ○ little	One person carrying the EU work alone is the most common bottleneck. Start where the admin is light: a short mobility (KA122), or join a project as partner, where the coordinator writes the application.
Partners we trust abroad ● ○ ○ little	Without partners you trust, coordinating is risky. Join other labs' projects first; use partner searches (Otlas, EPALE) and contact seminars; a job shadowing is a cheap way to test a partner.
Project management experience ● ○ ○ little	Start small to build a record: a short mobility (KA122) or a small-scale partnership (KA210), or be a partner and lead one clear part of a larger project.
Financial capability ● ● ○ some	Plan the cash gap between the start of a project and its final payment, and count any co-financing before you commit.
International projects experience ○ ○ ○	Not rated on the start screen.
Work with local communities ● ● ● solid	Your local roots are an asset: make them visible (the town hall as partner, open events, results used by the community).

WHAT YOU NEED MOST, AND WHICH REFERENCE PROJECT SERVES IT

Find partners abroad: European volunteers

Train our team: Youth Sensing

From where you stand to your 2030

What your lab must build, by when, and what builds it

WHERE YOU WANT TO BE

"The rural fablab where young people and artists repair and invent"

Your role by 2030: A coordinator

	2027 last calls under today's rules	2028 new Erasmus+ with the Solidarity Corps	2029–2034 the new programmes run
Reference projects	1 · 4 · 5	2	3

1 = Youth Sensing · 2 = European volunteers · 3 = ADaPT4Future: ADult People create Technologies for their Future · 4 = Technologijos kūrybai (Technologies for creativity) (no date yet, dashed) · 5 = 3D printing can bring learning for visual impaired to life (no date yet, dashed)

Partners we trust abroad

today little → some

by 2027: 2 people with 10 days a year for EU work

Built by: reference projects 1, 2, 3, 4, 5 · Network or peer lab

People and time

today little → some

by 2028: Not defined yet: how will you know you got there?

Built by: reference projects 1, 2, 4, 5 · Volunteers · Town hall

Project management experience

today little → some

Not defined yet: how will you know you got there?

Built by: reference projects 1, 3, 4, 5

Rules for your next initiatives

Drawn from your position, your 2030, your roadmap and your reference projects

1. **Say yes to a project only if it moves you towards your 2030.**
   "The rural fablab where young people and artists repair and invent" Projects that do not serve it cost the same work and leave less behind.

2. **Until 2027, build "Partners we trust abroad": from little to some.**
   Without partners you trust, coordinating is risky. Join other labs' projects first; use partner searches (Otlas, EPALE) and contact seminars; a job shadowing is a cheap way to test a partner. In your path: reference projects 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, Network or peer lab.

3. **Until 2028, build "People and time": from little to some.**
   One person carrying the EU work alone is the most common bottleneck. Start where the admin is light: a short mobility (KA122), or join a project as partner, where the coordinator writes the application. In your path: reference projects 1, 2, 4, 5, Volunteers, Town hall.

4. **Until 2028, build "Project management experience": from little to some.**
   Start small to build a record: a short mobility (KA122) or a small-scale partnership (KA210), or be a partner and lead one clear part of a larger project. In your path: reference projects 1, 3, 4, 5.

5. **Coordinate a small project before a large one.**
   Large partnerships and Creative Europe ask for a track record and financial capacity; a small-scale partnership builds both.

6. **Go only when: a partner you trust is on board three months before the deadline, someone has the time to write, and you can advance the costs.**
   In your path: before reference project 1, build partners we trust abroad; before reference project 3, build partners we trust abroad and project management experience.

7. **You start with mobility.**
   Good sequence: a mobility tests a method and lets you meet partners at low cost; the partnership that follows can be built on what you saw.

8. **Your path crosses programmes.**
   Make the link explicit: what does each step give the next one (people, method, partners, audience)? Evaluators reward continuity.

9. **AI rule one for this lab.**

10. **AI rule two for this lab.**

11. **Argue only for the priorities you select, and show them in the activities, the public and the results.**
    Inclusion is expected in almost every funded project: name who takes part and which barrier you lower. We found the opposite slip in our own forms, more than once.

12. **Prepare for 2028 without betting on details.**
    The new Erasmus+ (with the Solidarity Corps) and AgoraEU are still being negotiated. Trusted partners, results you can show and the horizontal priorities will count in any version.

13 **Review this roadmap with your team in November 2027.**

By then the 2028 calls and the new Programme Guide should be known. Change the projects, keep the rules.

What each one means for your lab

What it would build, what it pays, and the answers to your doubts

1 · Youth Sensing — KA152 · 2027

FOR YOUR LAB	AI PARALLEL for Youth Sensing. Second sentence about adapting it to your lab.
READY?	Build first: Find partners first: partner searches (Otlas, EPALE), contact seminars, or a short mobility that takes you to them.
IT WOULD BUILD	Partners we trust abroad, People and time, Project management experience
YOUR NEEDS IT SERVES	Train our team
PRIORITIES IN ITS APPLICATION	Topics (the 2019 form had no priority field): Civic engagement / responsible citizenship · ICT, new technologies, digital competences · Access for disadvantaged
WHAT IT PAYS	Unit costs per participant and per day. Organisational support: €125 per participant (leaders and facilitators excluded). Why: running the exchange or the training.

YOUR DOUBTS, ANSWERED

BUDGET AND MONEY

AI ANSWER about Budget and money.

FINDING PARTNERS

AI ANSWER about Finding partners.

2 · European volunteers — ESC · 2028

FOR YOUR LAB	AI PARALLEL for European volunteers. Second sentence about adapting it to your lab.
READY?	Ready to apply. Nothing missing from what you entered.
IT WOULD BUILD	Partners we trust abroad, People and time
YOUR NEEDS IT SERVES	Find partners abroad
PRIORITIES IN ITS APPLICATION	Volunteering project 2026, per activity: Inclusion and diversity · Environmental protection, sustainable development and climate action · Digital transition · Participation in democratic life
WHAT IT PAYS	Unit costs per volunteer and per day. The Quality Label itself carries no money: it is the door to apply. Organisational support: per volunteer per day, €27 in Portugal, €25 in Spain. Why: hosting, mentoring and supporting the volunteer.

YOUR DOUBTS, ANSWERED

PRIORITIES AND IMPACT

AI ANSWER about Priorities and impact.

DEADLINES

AI ANSWER about Deadlines.

YOUR QUESTION: HOW MUCH DO WE HAVE TO ADVANCE BEFORE THE EU PAYS?

AI ANSWER about How much do we have to advance before the EU pays?.

3 · ADaPT4Future: ADult People create Technologies for their Future

KA220 · Later

FOR YOUR LAB	AI PARALLEL for ADaPT4Future: ADult People create Technologies for their Future. Second sentence about adapting it to your lab.
READY?	Build first: Find partners first: partner searches (Otlas, EPALE), contact seminars, or a short mobility that takes you to them. Start smaller: a short mobility (KA122) or a small-scale partnership (KA210), or join a project like this as a partner.
IT WOULD BUILD	Partners we trust abroad, Project management experience
PRIORITIES	Partnerships choose one main priority and up to two more; inclusion is in almost all funded projects. The Results Platform lists this project's topics.
WHAT IT PAYS	A lump sum: €120,000, €250,000 or €400,000, split into work packages. One work package for project management (at most 20% of the budget) and up to four for implementation.

YOUR DOUBTS, ANSWERED

PARTNER OR COORDINATOR

AI ANSWER about Partner or coordinator.

WHAT CHANGES AFTER 2027

AI ANSWER about What changes after 2027.

4 · Technologijos kūrybai (Technologies for creativity)

KA122

FOR YOUR LAB	AI PARALLEL for Technologijos kūrybai (Technologies for creativity). Second sentence about adapting it to your lab.
READY?	Ready to apply. Nothing missing from what you entered.
IT WOULD BUILD	Partners we trust abroad, People and time, Project management experience
PRIORITIES	Partnerships choose one main priority and up to two more; inclusion is in almost all funded projects. The Results Platform lists this project's topics.
WHAT IT PAYS	Unit costs: fixed amounts per participant, per day and per distance. They do not need receipts, and they cover on average about 80% of real costs. Organisational support: €100 per participant on a course or training, €350 for job shadowing, teaching or short learner mobility. Why: the work of organising, for which no other category pays.

5 · 3D printing can bring learning for visual impaired to life — KA122

FOR YOUR LAB	AI PARALLEL for 3D printing can bring learning for visual impaired to life. Second sentence about adapting it to your lab.
READY?	Ready to apply. Nothing missing from what you entered.
IT WOULD BUILD	Partners we trust abroad, People and time, Project management experience
PRIORITIES	Partnerships choose one main priority and up to two more; inclusion is in almost all funded projects. The Results Platform lists this project's topics.
WHAT IT PAYS	Unit costs: fixed amounts per participant, per day and per distance. They do not need receipts, and they cover on average about 80% of real costs. Organisational support: €100 per participant on a course or training, €350 for job shadowing, teaching or short learner mobility. Why: the work of organising, for which no other category pays.

Your questions, answered

From our experience and the official rules

Can we be partners without previous projects?

> **FROM OUR EXPERIENCE**
>
> AI general answer to: Can we be partners without previous projects?

Programme Guide: small-scale partnerships — https://erasmus-plus.ec.europa.eu/programme-guide/part-b/key-action-2/small-scale-partnerships

Which agency do we apply to if we work with adults and artists?

> **FROM OUR EXPERIENCE**
>
> AI general answer to: Which agency do we apply to if we work with adults and artists?

Find your Erasmus+ National Agency — https://erasmus-plus.ec.europa.eu/contacts/national-agencies

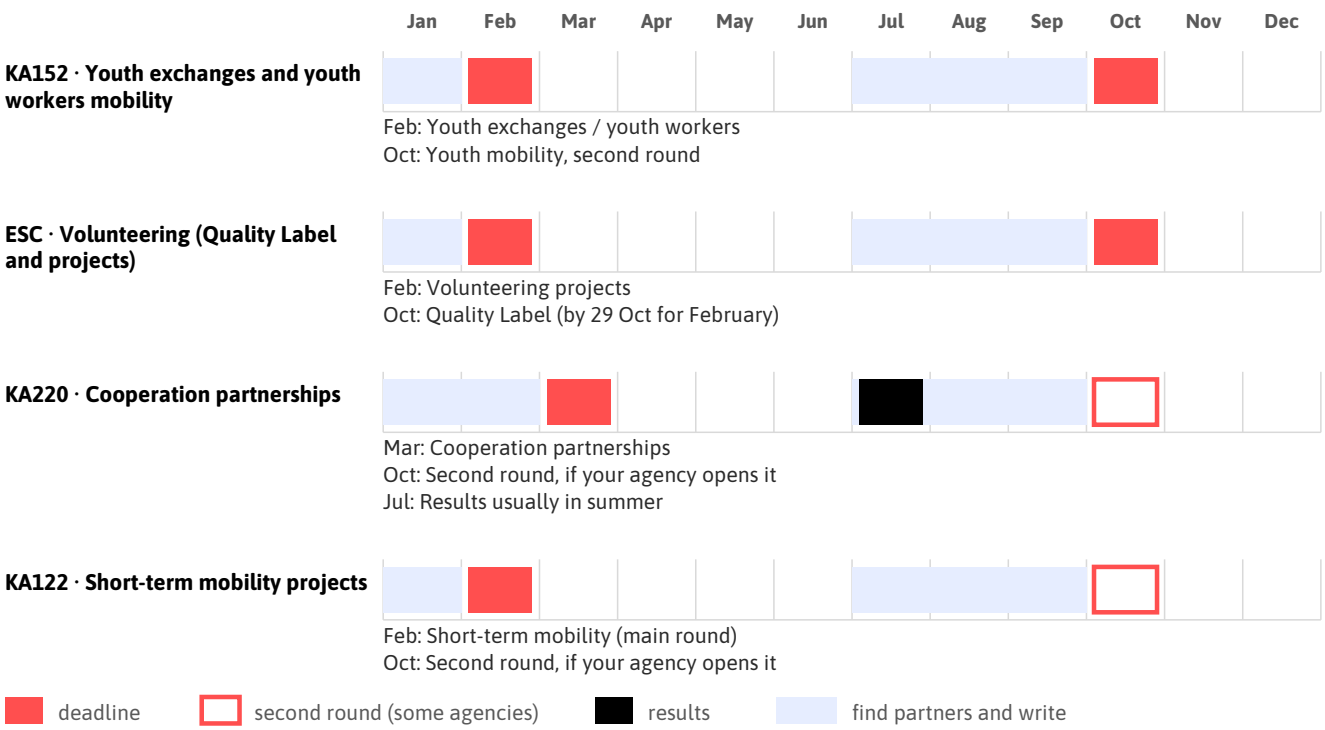
Can we bring our dog to Cuenca?

> **FROM OUR EXPERIENCE**
>
> AI general answer to: Can we bring our dog to Cuenca?

YOUR YEAR OF DEADLINES

When to apply, and where

A typical year based on the 2026 calls, for the actions in your path



WHERE THE CALLS ARE PUBLISHED

Erasmus+ National Agencies (where you apply for most Erasmus+ actions) — https://erasmus-plus.ec.europa.eu/contacts/national-agencies

Erasmus+ Programme Guide 2026 (rules and deadlines) — https://erasmus-plus.ec.europa.eu/programme-guide/erasmusplus-programme-guide

EU Funding & Tenders Portal (Creative Europe, CERV calls) — https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/portal/screen/opportunities/calls-for-proposals

Creative Europe Desks (free advice in your country) — https://culture.ec.europa.eu/resources/creative-europe-desks

European Solidarity Corps Quality Label — https://youth.europa.eu/solidarity/organisations/quality-label_en

Talk to partners three months before each deadline. Results of partnerships usually arrive in summer, Creative Europe in November, and projects start months later: plan cash for the gap.

A checklist for the long term

For competent applications, and for projects that connect into a path

EVERY APPLICATION

- [ ] Your organisation is registered (OID for Erasmus+, PIC for Creative Europe) and the data are up to date.
- [ ] You know which field and which agency each application goes to.
- [ ] Each partner has confirmed in writing, and you know who signs the declarations.
- [ ] You checked caps per organisation and per round, and that the same group is not in two applications.
- [ ] You have the last two years of accounts ready.
- [ ] You can advance costs until the final payment.
- [ ] You keep a folder of evidence: participants, photos, outputs, press.
- [ ] You have read the evaluation criteria before writing.

YOUR LONG-TERM VIEW

- [ ] Networks: Which networks are you active in, not only a member of?
- [ ] Partnerships: Which partner would you trust with your money and your name?
- [ ] Financial capacity and cash flow: Can you advance costs for months?
- [ ] Programme diversification: Which second programme fits a theme you already have?
- [ ] Complementarity between programmes and actions: How does one of your projects prepare the next?
- [ ] Annual planning: Which three deadlines will you really meet next year?
- [ ] Role: partner or coordinator: Where can you be a partner now, and coordinate in two years?
- [ ] Local anchoring: Who locally would sign a letter of support tomorrow?
- [ ] Compliance: Who checks signatures, registration numbers and caps per round in your team?
- [ ] Positioning for 2028: What do you want to be able to show in 2028?

CHOOSING PARTNERS

- [ ] Complementarity: What does each partner bring that the others do not? A method, a public, a sector, a city.
- [ ] Trust: Partners you have already worked with, or who answer and deliver on time. Most of our projects started from a previous one.
- [ ] Financial capacity: Who can receive, advance and co-finance money? Above €60,000 the EU can check the applicant's accounts (public bodies are exempt).
- [ ] Sector: The field you apply in (schools, adults, youth, vocational, culture) decides the agency and who can credibly coordinate.
- [ ] Size: How many partners and countries the action asks for, and how many you can really manage.

WHAT WE LEARNED ON THE WAY (BUINHO, SINCE 2015)

· Fewer, better applications. Our proposals with strong concepts and partners we trust do well; when we write too many at once, quality drops.

· Keep a few long-term themes and do not drift from them. Inside the same theme, design each project to fit what each programme is looking for.

· Think of small projects as steps. A small-scale partnership can be designed so that its own activities prepare a larger cooperation project.

· Make mobilities from different projects coincide where you can, so the same people and the same trip serve more than one project.

· Administration can sink a good project. A missing or wrong signature on a declaration made two of our applications ineligible, and an approved project was lost because the grant was not signed in time.